

► c.2ND CENTURY BCE

INVENTION OF PAPER

Before the invention of paper by a resourceful Chinese civil servant called Cai Lun, writers used parchment, papyrus, or palm leaves.



PAPER AND BRUSH

► c.700–1500 CE

ARABIAN NIGHTS

Arabian Nights (also called *One Thousand and One Nights*) is a collection of captivating stories compiled over many centuries. Two of the best known are *Ali Baba and the Forty Thieves* and *Sinbad the Sailor*.

“Open Sesame!”

(*Ali Baba and the Forty Thieves*)

► c.750–1000

BEOWULF

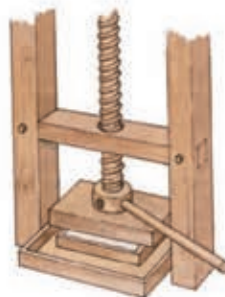
Beowulf is an Old English poem about good and evil. The hero, Beowulf, destroys a terrible monster and then a dragon, but is killed during his last battle.

“When a chance came, he caught the hero in a rush of flame and clamped sharp fangs into his neck.”

► 1440

THE PRINTING PRESS

The invention of the printing press by Johannes Gutenberg changed everything. Many more books were available, and ordinary people could own them for the first time.



THE PRINTING PRESS

► c.1595

ROMEO AND JULIET

William Shakespeare wrote 37 brilliant plays and many sonnets. One of his most famous plays, *Romeo and Juliet*, tells the tragic story of two young lovers whose families are fierce rivals.



ROMEO'S POISON AND DAGGER

“O Romeo, Romeo, wherefore art thou Romeo?”

◀ 1831

THE HUNCHBACK OF NOTRE DAME

Up in the towers of the Notre Dame Cathedral in Paris lives the hunchback Quasimodo. In Victor Hugo's story this tragic hero tries to save a kind gypsy dancer from death.



NOTRE DAME CATHEDRAL

◀ 1813

“Angry people are not always wise.”

PRIDE AND PREJUDICE

Finding husbands for five daughters is a major challenge in the Bennet family. Jane Austen's complicated romance between Elizabeth Bennet and Mr Darcy is now a classic romance.

◀ 1812

GRIMMS' FAIRY TALES

The Brothers Grimm wrote many gruesome fairy tales with wicked characters that still frighten and thrill children today. *Little Snow White* and *Little Red Riding Hood* are two of the most famous.

“Mirror, mirror, on the wall, who in this land is the fairest of all?”

(*Little Snow White*)

◀ 18TH CENTURY



A TRADITIONAL CHINESE FAN

DREAM OF THE RED CHAMBER

This classic Chinese novel by Cao Xueqin is about the rise and fall of the aristocratic Jia family. It has a huge number of characters and paints a vivid picture of life in 18th-century China.

◀ 1605

DON QUIXOTE

Don Quixote sets out on his lanky horse Rocinante with his sidekick Sancho Panza on a donkey. Miguel de Cervantes' hero is in search of a knightly quest and a maiden to woo, but most of his adventures happen inside his head.

“Can we ever have too much of a good thing?”

► 1950



THE WARDROBE

THE LION, THE WITCH AND THE WARDROBE

C S Lewis set his adventures in Narnia – the mysterious world of ice and snow that four children discover through a door at the back of a wardrobe.

► 1952

CHARLOTTE'S WEB

Wilbur the pig is saved from slaughter by a supportive spider called Charlotte who weaves flattering messages about him in her web. E B White's heart-warming story has been a favourite for more than 60 years.



CHARLOTTE IN HER WEB

► 1960



THE MOCKINGBIRD IS A SYMBOL OF INNOCENCE

TO KILL A MOCKINGBIRD

Two children learn harsh lessons about equality in Harper Lee's explosive novel set in Alabama, USA. Their lawyer father defends a black man who is accused of a crime he did not commit.

► 1988

THE ALCHEMIST

Paulo Coelho's young shepherd, Santiago, tries to fulfil his Personal Legend by hunting for treasure. He learns valuable lessons on his journey.



SANTIAGO SEEKS TREASURE AT THE PYRAMIDS

► 1997

HARRY POTTER AND THE PHILOSOPHER'S STONE

The *Harry Potter* series by J K Rowling is about the adventures of a special young wizard called Harry and his schoolfriends. In this first story, an evil wizard hunts for the Philosopher's Stone so he can live forever.



THE SORTING HAT TELLS STUDENTS WHICH SCHOOL HOUSE THEY WILL BE IN

► 2005



BURNING BOOKS

THE BOOK THIEF

Markus Zusak's novel is narrated by death. He tells the touching story of a young girl who steals books in Germany during World War II.